

Gresham College

No. 166

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

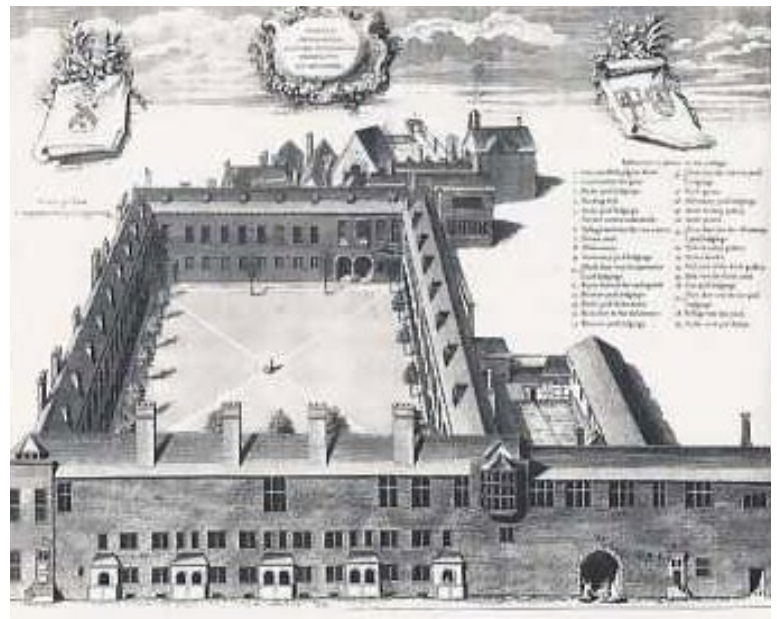
April 2026

Gresham College is a famous college that was started in 1579 by Sir Thomas Gresham, a rich London merchant. He left his money to create a college where seven Professors gave free lectures to the public. The first lecture took place in 1597.

Many famous people, including Christopher Wren and Robert Hooke, taught or studied there. The College helped support important new ideas and discoveries. Although it faced many problems over the years, it survived. Since 1989, Gresham College has grown again, with its free lectures now watched online by people all over the world.



Sir Thomas Gresham



Gresham College 1740